state as such. Frankel[23] points out six reasons for the survival of territorial states despite several crises challenging them. They are:

1. States generally retain their legitimacy, both domestically and internationally.
2. They remain the largest-scale meaningful communities and command supreme loyalty of the vast majority of their citizens, particularly as political representatives of nations and as guardians of national cultures.
3. They retain the monopoly of territory and the near monopoly of large-scale legitimate force.
4. They remain the only truly comprehensive large-scale multifunctional organizations with great built-in powers of inertia due to the built-in bureaucratic and other sectional interests, which have a stake in their survival.
5. Negatively, they have not been generally faced with really serious rivals.
6. Perhaps most importantly, as the discontinuation of any state could undermine the stability of the international system as a whole and threaten others with a possibility of a major war, disastrous to all, everybody has now a substantial stake in the continuation of the status quo.

Therefore, while acknowledging the growing importance of non-state actors, it has to be admitted also that sovereign states would continue to be the basic unit of international system. No viable alternative institution is thinkable in the distant future. It is true that interdependence and interpenetration of domestic and international politics, the movement of capital and information, forces of globalization, technological innovations, newer weaponry, the increasing influence of transnational social movements and organizations pose challenges to the state's supremacy, yet, these do not mean the end of the state as the primary unit in international relations. The state system is now facing new challenges, internationally and also on the domestic front, to which it has to adjust, and its survival remains linked to such adjustments.